

In addition to the benefits Berman outlined, there are options like being an RA (Resident Assistant) in an on-campus dorm, allowing you to eliminate your housing costs. Other positions within a university can allow you to eliminate tuition. The take-home message is that working while going to school is one pillar to hacking college. By strategically seeking out work opportunities, you can get far more value than the dollar figure you see on a paycheck.

Before going to college, Berman also spent a lot of time researching another pillar of hacking college: scholarships. Many people don't bother trying for scholarships. They see it as an all-or-none proposition with little chance of getting their schooling paid for. So they don't bother trying.

Berman advises looking for scholarships offered through organizations within your community, specific schools you're interested in, or those associated with your nationality, your major, life circumstances, or interests unique to you. He then advises applying for as many scholarships as you're eligible for.

He makes a great point; developing a process of mass applying for many scholarships gives you pretty good odds of at least getting a few. These scholarships can be worth a couple hundred to a couple thousand dollars apiece. He said getting even a few small